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Highline Public Schools Sued Over Alleged Systemic Public Records Act Violations and Unreasonable Delays

SEATTLE, WA — A formal lawsuit has been filed in King County Superior Court against **Highline Public Schools** (Case No. 26-2-23235-1 SEA), alleging widespread violations of Washington's Public Records Act (RCW 42.56). The action claims the School District routinely uses arbitrary, multi-month extensions to delay the release of public documents, suppressing transparency around district governance and administrative operations.

The complaint, assigned to **Department 02 (Judge Kristin Ballinger)**, highlights a growing pattern where routine requests—including native software tracking logs and basic administrative metadata generated automatically by the District's GovQA portal—are routinely pushed out by 10 to 12 weeks.

Under Washington law (**RCW 42.56.520**), agencies responding to public records requests must provide a reasonable estimate of time based on the actual effort required to process the request. The lawsuit alleges that Highline Public Schools uses boilerplate responses to extend deadlines arbitrarily, depriving parents, advocates, and the community of timely public oversight.

Recent documentation demonstrates that even after being served with legal notice, the District issued notices extending basic electronic database reporting to **September 29, 2026**.

"Public oversight of school district governance is impossible when basic transparency requests are intentionally locked behind automated multi-month delays," said Plaintiff Kristen Price. *"Washington law requires prompt access to public records, not standardized stalling tactics."*

The Plaintiff is seeking court orders compelling immediate production of withheld records, statutory daily penalties under **RCW 42.56.550**, and court costs.